

Cat Constant Meowing Fix — Action Checklist

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MEDICAL INVESTIGATION

- ☐ **Medical Investigation:** Request a T4 thyroid panel test to check for hyperthyroidism, which commonly causes increased vocalization as an early symptom before weight loss or other obvious signs appear.
- ☐ **Medical Investigation:** Request an SDMA blood test to detect early-stage kidney disease, as cats with chronic kidney disease frequently vocalize more—especially during nighttime hours when they're restless.
- ☐ **Medical Investigation:** Ask your vet to assess your cat for chronic pain conditions like arthritis, which cats instinctively hide and often express through increased vocalization when moving or being handled.
- ☐ **Medical Investigation:** Seek a veterinary behaviorist referral if all medical tests return normal but excessive vocalization persists beyond one year, as prescription medication can support long-term behavior retraining.

TRACK MEOWING PATTERNS

- ☐ **Track Meowing Patterns:** Record each meowing episode for at least 7 consecutive days, noting time of day, location, what you were doing beforehand, your cat's behavior before meowing started, and your response.
- ☐ **Track Meowing Patterns:** Document how long each meowing episode lasts and what eventually stops it, which reveals whether the behavior self-terminates or continues until you respond with attention or action.
- ☐ **Track Meowing Patterns:** Identify which of four vocalization patterns your cat exhibits—pre-feeding, post-isolation, demand-driven, or ambient anxiety—because each pattern requires a different retraining approach.
- ☐ **Track Meowing Patterns:** Stop all interventions until the 7-day log is complete, because random attempts to fix the behavior can accidentally reinforce it and make the problem worse before you understand it.

RETRAIN THE BEHAVIOR

- ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Implement total extinction by removing every response to meowing, including verbal scolding, eye contact, physical comfort, and even sighing, because any response trains the cat to keep meowing.

 - ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Introduce an alternative quiet behavior and reward it with treats, play, or affection immediately, so your cat learns that silence produces better results than persistent vocalization.

 - ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Feed meals at consistent, predictable times every day to eliminate food-demand meowing, because irregular feeding schedules teach cats that meowing gets food attention.

 - ☐ **Retrain the Behavior:** Reduce household stress using pheromone diffusers, consistent daily routines, and night lights for senior cats, because ambient anxiety contributes significantly to ongoing vocalization.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.